

Ballast — video production plan

Four features, shown properly. A presenter on camera, two short drama beats, keyword graphics, and demos long enough to actually understand.

Target 4:37

Hard limit 5:00

8 scenes

~650 spoken words

3 locations · 1 shoot day

This revision: four features, nothing else

The previous plan showed nine features in fourteen scenes. Every one got twenty seconds, which is long enough to see a screen and too short to understand it. This one shows **four**, and gives each of them **two to three times** the screen time:

🎓 **Timetable** · 📄 **Owing** · ⭐ **What to do first** · 👥 **Friends**

Cut entirely: the swap, capture and the five dials, the five-area check-in, recovery, Tonight, the collision warning, the rebalancer and the decline drafter. They stay in the README, which is where Ideation is marked anyway.

One thing carried over on purpose. `load = hours × dread` is not a feature and gets no demo — but it is the reason Owing and the priority list are not an ordinary to-do app, so it stays as **one sentence** in the presenter's opening. Cut that sentence and the four features below read like a calendar.

The rubric — and exactly what full marks says

Presentation is **15%** of the total. Green is the band this plan is built to land in.

CRITERION	%	0–1	2–3	FULL MARKS
Clarity of explanation	5%	Confusing; idea not understandable.	Understandable but patchy.	4–5 · The idea is explained clearly and is easy to grasp.
Structure and flow	4%	Disorganised, hard to follow.	Some structure but jumps around.	4 · Logical, well-paced flow from problem to solution.
Delivery and confidence	4%	Hesitant or flat, hard to engage with.	Reasonably confident, some energy.	4 · Confident, engaging, and convincing.
Engagement and persuasiveness	2%	0 · Doesn't make the idea feel worth building.	1 · Somewhat compelling.	2 · Makes the idea feel genuinely valuable and exciting.

Why four features scores better than nine. Clarity is the biggest single line at 5%, and it is awarded for *the idea being easy to grasp* — not for coverage. Nine features in five minutes is a list; four features shown end to end is an argument. Structure and flow (4%) is the same bet: four blocks in one order is a shape a viewer can hold.

The host's hint, quoted

"Your **Ideation (25%)** is judged solely from your **README.md**, not your video, which means you do not have to spend time in your video discussing all the ideas you had and why they were dropped. Spend the 5 minutes you have to explain **your idea** to the viewer, **why it is novel**, **how it will be built**, and **why it deserves to be built**. You will lose marks for Presentation (15%) if your video exceeds the 5 minute limit (as stated in the rubrics)."

Where the time goes

FEATURE	SCREEN TIME	WHY THAT MUCH
 Friends 	65s	The mentor's note: this is the differentiator, so push it. Seven beats — the circle, how old each reading is, the one nudge, a friend's published calendar, your own privacy screen, three shared evenings, and contact matching.
 What to do first	45s	The question a student actually asks. Both halves — what first, and what you are allowed to move — plus the evening question that re-tunes the ranking.
 Owing	45s	The most original of the three solo features, and the hardest to build: work that sits on every day until it is done, and a planner that books the sittings for you.
 Timetable	40s	The set-up moment. Paste, flag, and the attendance arithmetic running underneath.
Everything else · 0s. The swap, capture, the five areas, recovery, Tonight, the wall, the rebalancer, the decline drafter.		

DRAMA	PRESENTER · THE IDEA	 TIMETABLE	 OWING	 WHAT FIRST	 FRIENDS	BUILT · THE PLAN	CLOSE
-------	----------------------	---	---	--	---	------------------	-------

Four amber-and-red blocks, in one order, each long enough to follow. Demo is **70%** of the running time, and the close carries a dated build plan rather than a promise.

The word budget — check this before you record

A script that reads well on paper and runs forty seconds long is the most common way teams lose the Presentation mark, and you only find out after the shoot. At a steady **140 words per minute**, this is what each scene can hold. **If you rewrite a line, keep the count.**

SCENE	PICTURE	WORDS ALLOWED	WORDS WRITTEN	NOTES
1 · Drama	14s	33	35	First 5s is room tone with no narration, so it fits.
2 · Presenter	20s	47	48	
3 ·  Timetable	40s	93	98	Pauses land on the flag taps.
4 ·  Owing	45s	105	109	Hold silent while the sittings appear.
5 ·  What first	45s	105	109	
6 ·  Friends	65s	152	150	Seven beats — do not hurry the sharing screen.
7 · Built	30s	70	64	The three-week graphic carries beat b; do not talk over it.
8 · Close	18s	42	39	Last 3s is the end card in silence.
Total		647	652	4:39 spoken against 4:37 of picture. The difference is the eight seconds of deliberate silence above. At a more natural 150 wpm it comes in at 4:20 .

Read it aloud with a stopwatch before the shoot day. If your natural pace puts you over 4:50, use the trim order at the end of this plan — not an on-the-day guess.

Cast, locations, kit

Cast — two people is now enough

- **PRESENTER.** Your most confident speaker. On camera in scenes 2, 7, 8; in voice-over throughout. **Same outfit all day.**
- **STUDENT A.** The drama lead, scenes 1 and 6a. **No dialogue at all** — cast whoever is most relaxed on camera, not the best talker.
- The two extras from the old plan are no longer needed.

Locations — three

- **DESK / BEDROOM, night.** Scenes 1, 6a, 8 end.
- **OUTDOOR or plain wall, day.** Scenes 2, 7, 8 — every presenter piece.
- **LAPTOP / desk, day.** Scene 7 inserts.

The library and corridor shoots are gone with the scenes that used them.

Kit. A phone on a tripod is fine in 1080p. What matters: **the microphone** — record narration separately, indoors, into earbuds or a cheap lav, never an on-camera mic outdoors. And **daylight on the face**: stand facing a window, or with the sun behind the camera.

Before you capture a single screen — read this

1. Open the app → **You** → **Reset**. (It used to be under Areas. That screen is gone.) Confirm Home reads **47%** and "Doing fine". Every number spoken in this script comes from that state.
2. **The evening question only appears after 8pm.** Scene 5d needs it on screen, so capture that beat after 20:00 — or set the device clock forward. It is the only time-gated thing in the app.
3. **Scene 6c and 6g open WhatsApp for real.** Let the share sheet appear, then cut. Nothing sends unless you press send.
4. Scene 6f: `/plan-together` opens with **Amin and Ravi** picked and **Dinner · 2h**. Leave them — that is the state that produces three windows.

Rehearse against the real footage — `docs/video/clips/player.html`

Every demo beat below has been recorded from the live app at **exactly** the timings in this plan. Open that file in a browser, press **space**, and read the script aloud beside it. If you finish a scene before its bar does you are too fast; if the clock turns red you are over five minutes.

- **Camera scenes hold a card** for their real length, so the whole 4:37 can be rehearsed, not only the demos.
- **Click any scene** in the right-hand column to rehearse it alone. `#scene=6` or `#t=200` in the address bar does the same.
- **Regenerate after any change** with `npm run clips`, or `node scripts/clips.mjs --player-only` to rebuild just the page.

The recording drives the real app over Chrome DevTools — it taps the flags, presses "Book 2 sittings for me", toggles the sharing screen. Two things it fakes, both deliberately: the clock is pinned to 21:00 so Home shows the evening question, and `window.open` is stubbed so the WhatsApp beats do not navigate away mid-capture.

The shooting script

Every scene states **who** is in it, **where** it is shot, **what** happens and **how** to frame it. Long scenes are broken into lettered beats with their own timings. **Red** is the beat that must land on the cut.

TIME	WHAT / HOW / WHO / WHERE	SAY	ON SCREEN
0:00 14s DRAMA IDEA	WHAT — Sunday, 1:47am. STUDENT A at a messy desk, blank document, phone buzzing. They open a to-do app: "3 tasks today." They close it and stare at nothing. HOW — Three shots, ~4s each. Clock · blank doc over-shoulder · wide of stillness. Handheld is fine. WHO — STUDENT A, no dialogue. WHERE — Desk, lights low.	<i>First five seconds: no narration. Room tone only.</i> "It's Sunday night. Your planner says three tasks." It doesn't say one of them is a presentation you've dreaded all week. It doesn't know you're the only one who hasn't seen anybody in a fortnight."	SUNDAY · 01:47 3 tasks today
0:14 20s PRESENTER IDEA	WHAT — Piece to camera. Name the flaw, name the product, promise the four things. HOW — Mid-shot, chest up, off-centre with space on the lens side. Eyes on the lens. Two-second insert of laundry and a lecture theatre on "an hour of laundry". WHO — PRESENTER. WHERE — Outdoor / plain wall, daylight.	"I'm [NAME]. Every planner ever made counts hours. " But an hour of laundry is not an hour of a group presentation. So Ballast counts hours times dread — and that one change makes four things possible. Your timetable. Your assignments. What to do first. And your friends."	EVERY PLANNER COUNTS HOURS load = hours x dread BALLAST title card
0:34 40s DEMO NOVEL FEATURE 1	WHAT — 📅 Timetable. The set-up moment, in full. HOW — Four beats, voice-over throughout, all screen capture. a · 10s /timetable/import — paste a block of timetable text and let the preview list build itself. Hold on the "could not read" line. b · 14s /timetable — tap "Gives exam tips", then "Attendance counted". Let each chip fill before the next tap. c · 10s Scroll up and hold on the red "Algorithms attendance · CS2011 78%" card. d · 6s Press "View these in my week" and land on Plan with the classes on the clock. WHO — Voice-over. WHERE — Screen capture.	"Start with the biggest thing in a student's week — and the thing every planner makes you type by hand." Paste your timetable straight from your portal. Any format. Anything it can't read, it hands back rather than quietly dropping. Then flag the lectures that matter more. This one gives exam tips. This one takes a register. Because a lecture is just an hour in a box until it's the one where the hints get given. Flag it, and nothing here will ever move it. And the arithmetic runs underneath: you're on seventy-eight percent . You need eighty."	PASTE · DON'T RETYPE IT HANDS BACK WHAT IT CAN'T READ 💡 GIVES EXAM TIPS 78% — YOU NEED 80%
1:14 45s DEMO NOVEL FEATURE 2	WHAT — 📄 Owing. Work that is owing, not work that is today. HOW — Five beats, all screen capture. a · 10s /plan — scroll to the Owing band. Hold on all three	"Here's what every to-do list gets wrong. An assignment due Thursday isn't a task <i>on</i> Thursday. It's nine hours spread across the days before	NOT A TASK — HOURS OWED DONE · BOOKED · LOOSE

1:59
45s

DEMO

FEATURE 3

NOVEL

cards.

b · 10s Hold on one card's three-part bar and point at each section as it is named.

c · 8s Tap the Algorithms card → /item/algo-set . Hold on "3h still to do · 25%".

d · 12s Press "Book 2 sittings for me" and hold on the result. Do not rush this — it is the single strongest proof the thing is real.

e · 5s Tap "+1h" under "did some without booking it" and let the bar move.

WHO — Voice-over. **WHERE** — Screen capture.

Thursday.

So it sits on every single day until it's done. It can't hide at the bottom of a list.

And it tracks three things, because they're genuinely different: hours finished, hours booked, and hours still loose. Loose hours are the ones that become a Wednesday night.

Then this. It books your sittings for you — two hours at a time, into gaps that actually exist. Never on top of a lecture.

And it tells you the hours it can't fit."

IT PLANS YOUR SITTINGS

AND SAYS WHAT WON'T FIT

1:59
45s

DEMO

FEATURE 3

NOVEL

WHAT — ★ What to do first, both halves, and the question that tunes it.

HOW — Four beats, all screen capture.

a · 12s /priority — scroll slowly enough that three or four reason chips are readable: "Due today", "Hard deadline", "Not enough time left".

b · 10s Hold on row 1 — the black numbered disc and its one bright action.

c · 10s Scroll on to Could move and hold on a row with its "back" figure.

d · 13s Shot after 8pm: Home → tap "Too full" on the evening card → cut back to /priority and hold on the line at the foot of the list.

WHO — Voice-over. **WHERE** — Screen capture. Beat d must be shot in the evening.

"Twelve things, no idea where to start. A list sorts by what you typed first. A calendar sorts by the clock. Neither of those is importance.

So everything goes on one scale — how close the deadline is, who you promised, and whether it can still be finished at all. And every row says why it's there.

Then the half nobody asks: what are you actually allowed to move?

And once a day, late, it asks one question. Say your days were too full often enough, and the ranking itself changes.

Keep to your plan and it asks less often. It has to earn the interruption."

WHAT TO DO FIRST

A REASON ON EVERY ROW

...AND WHAT YOU MAY DROP

IT LEARNS YOUR PRIORITIES

2:44
65s

DRAMA

DEMO

FEATURE 4 · HERO

NOVEL · WHY

WHAT — 👤 Friends. The longest block in the video by a distance, on the mentor's advice. Seven beats, no pause between them.

HOW —

a · 8s Drama. STUDENT A types "you free this week?" into a group chat, hovers, deletes it. Desk, night.

b · 12s /friends — hold on the four rows: 8% · 62% · 71% · 24%. Then hold on Jo's "3

"And then the one that isn't about work at all.

Nobody sees their friends in week ten, because everyone assumes everyone else is busier. So nobody asks.

Four people, four batteries — and how old each reading is. Jo at twenty-four percent three

"you free this week?"

struck through

62% · 24% · 8% · 71%

UPDATED 22 MIN AGO

HEAVY FOR 11 DAYS

days ago · may be out of date".

c · 7s Hold on "MAYBE CHECK ON — Aisyah, heavy for 11 days", press the button, and let WhatsApp open with the message already written. Cut before sending.

d · 14s Tap Ravi → /friend/ravi . Hold four full seconds on the published week — filled blocks and empty ones.

e · 12s Back, tap your own row → /sharing . Switch "Evenings only" → "Nothing" → back, so the preview underneath visibly empties and refills.

f · 8s /plan-together — tap Aisyah on and watch the options fall, then tap her off. Hold on Wed 12 Nov, 6pm–8pm.

g · 4s /find-friends — hold on "3 already here".

WHO — STUDENT A, then screen. WHERE — Desk, then capture.

days ago is not the same claim as twenty-four percent this morning.

One person to check on. Ever. Aisyah has been running empty for eleven days — so it writes the message and opens WhatsApp .

Tap anyone and you see their week — but only the free parts. Filled blocks are time they chose to give you. Empty ones just say 'taken'. There's no field for what they're doing.

And this is your side of it. This is exactly what Ravi sees . 'Nothing' means nothing.

Then it finds the evenings that work for everybody .

Found from your contacts, matched on your phone ."

FREE TIME
ONLY · NEVER
WHAT THEY'RE
DOING

THIS IS WHAT
THEY SEE

3 EVENINGS
THAT WORK

3:49

30s

PRESENTER

BUILT

WHAT — Where this goes after the prototype. Not "it could be built" — the actual plan, with a date on it.

HOW — Three beats. Presenter beside a laptop, turning the screen to the lens, with inserts over the voice.

a · 8s On the presenter. Insert: the live URL typed into a browser, and the app loading. Then a 4x sped-up recording of npm run preflight finishing green.

b · 12s Full-screen graphic — the three-week plan as a bar, one block per week, built from README §5.3. Each block names what ships. Let each block appear on the word.

c · 10s The bar extends to weeks 4–8 in a lighter tone, then cut back to the presenter for the last line.

WHO — PRESENTER. WHERE — Laptop / desk, daylight.

"Everything you just saw is live today , works with no network, and passes eight hundred and eighty-one automated checks.

What it doesn't have is accounts. So the three weeks after finals are one thing only — a Node and Postgres API, Firebase sign-in, and local-first sync .

Then weeks four to eight: the timetable feed, notifications, and friends syncing between real accounts."

LIVE TODAY ·
WORKS
OFFLINE

881
AUTOMATED
CHECKS

WK 1 · API +
AUTH

WK 2 · SYNC

WK 3 · SHIP TO
TESTFLIGHT

WK 4–8 · FEEDS
· PUSH ·
FRIENDS

4:19

18s

PRESENTER

WHY

WHAT — The close.

HOW — Step half a metre closer than scene 2 so the frame is tighter; it reads as conviction. Slow down. On the last line, cut to STUDENT A from the cold open closing the laptop and turning the lamp off.

WHO — PRESENTER, then

"Every wellbeing app tells a drowning student to breathe. Ballast tells them which three things to put down — then asks when they last saw their friends.

Nothing else does both.

3 WEEKS TO
SYNC

End card, 3s in
silence:

BALLAST

load-balancer-
ballast.expo.app

STUDENT A. **WHERE** — Wall,
then desk.

Ballast. The weight you carry
on purpose."

Shot list, grouped by location

Shoot in this order, not script order. Two cast members, three locations, one day — and screen capture is now more than two thirds of the video.

BLOCK	SCENES	WHO	SHOTS TO GET
A · Outdoor / wall daylight, ~30 min	2, 7, 8	Presenter	All three presenter pieces back to back, two takes minimum each . Scene 8 framed tighter than scene 2. Grab 10s of the presenter silent and smiling as a cutaway safety net.
B · Desk, night lamp only, ~25 min	1, 6a, 8 end	Student A	Clock close-up · blank doc over-shoulder · wide of stillness · two takes of typing "you free this week?" and deleting it · laptop closing and lamp off.
C · Laptop, day ~10 min	7 inserts	—	Live URL typed into a browser and the app loading · a terminal running <code>npm run preflight</code> to green (shoot it long, speed it up later) · the README §5.2 architecture diagram on screen as a safety cutaway. The three-week bar in beat b is a made graphic, not a screen — see below.
D · Screen capture no cast, ~35 min	3–6	—	Timetable: <code>/timetable/import</code> <code>paste</code> · <code>/timetable</code> two flag taps · the 78% card · "View these in my week". Owing: <code>/plan</code> Owing band · the three-part bar · <code>/item/algo-set</code> · "Book 2 sittings for me" · the "+1h" tap. What first: <code>/priority</code> slow scroll · row 1 · Could move · Home evening card after 8pm · back to <code>/priority</code> . Friends: <code>/friends</code> four rows and the stale line · the Aisyah nudge into WhatsApp · <code>/friend/ravi</code> · <code>/sharing</code> toggling · <code>/plan-together</code> · <code>/find-friends</code> .
E · Narration indoors, quiet, ~20 min	all	Presenter	Record the entire script in one sitting, including the on-camera lines. Save one file per scene — eight files, named <code>01</code> to <code>08</code> . It makes every demo clip trivial to cut to length.

Routes that no longer exist. If you are working from an older plan, these will show a not-found screen: `/areas` , `/areas/social` , `/areas/mental` , `/actions` . Nothing in *this* script touches them. **Reset now lives on the You tab.**

The one graphic you have to make

Everything else on screen is either the app or a text card. This is the exception, and it is the only place in five minutes where the video answers the host's "how will it be built". Build it in Canva, Figma or Keynote at 1920x1080. **Every word below comes from README §5.3 — do not invent new scope for the video.**

WEEK 1 API + AUTH	WEEK 2 SYNC IN THE APP	WEEK 3 SHIP IT	WEEKS 4–8 · FEEDS · PUSH · FRIENDS SYNCING
----------------------	---------------------------	-------------------	--

Three solid blocks, then a lighter one. The tone change is the point: the first three weeks are committed, the rest is the road after them.

BLOCK	LABEL ON SCREEN	SUB-LINE, IF IT FITS	APPEARS ON THE WORDS...
Week 1	API + AUTH	Express · Postgres · Firebase sign-in	"a Node and Postgres API, Firebase sign-in"
Week 2	SYNC IN THE APP	Local-first write queue · works in aeroplane mode	"and local-first sync"
Week 3	SHIP IT	CI · Sentry · TestFlight · buffer	(appears with week 2; no separate line)

Say the scope decision out loud if you have a spare second. The strongest thing about this roadmap is what it *leaves out*: three weeks buys **one vertical slice finished**, not five things half-built. Panels have seen a hundred teams promise everything by week three. If the cut runs short, the line to add in beat c is: *"Three weeks buys one thing done properly, not five things half-done."*

Keyword graphics

Twenty-one text cards, but only four are full-screen — the rest sit over the demo. One font, one weight, one position per type. Motion is a fade or a 6-frame slide; nothing spinning.

Full-screen — 3–4s on a colour panel

load = hours × dread **BALLAST**

881 AUTOMATED CHECKS

load-balancer-ballast.expo.app

Lower third — over footage, 2s

EVERY PLANNER COUNTS HOURS

PASTE · DON'T RETYPE

IT HANDS BACK WHAT IT CAN'T READ

NOT A TASK — HOURS OWED

A REASON ON EVERY ROW

IT LEARNS YOUR PRIORITIES

FREE TIME ONLY · NEVER WHAT
THEY'RE DOING

Pinned to the UI — tracks the screen

💡 GIVES EXAM TIPS

78% — YOU NEED 80%

DONE · BOOKED · LOOSE

IT PLANS YOUR SITTINGS

AND SAYS WHAT WON'T FIT

WHAT TO DO FIRST

...AND WHAT YOU MAY DROP

62% · 24% · 8% · 71%

HEAVY FOR 11 DAYS

THIS IS WHAT THEY SEE

Plus full subtitles throughout. Assume part of the panel watches muted.

Edit and performance

Assembly order

1. Lay the **eight narration files** end to end in order. That is your spine, and its total length is your runtime — check it is under 4:40 before you cut a single picture.
2. Drop the three presenter pieces onto their lines, synced by waveform.
3. Fill with demo capture, beat by beat. Speed screen recordings to **1.2x** — UI always plays slower than it feels.
4. Cut the two drama beats in last.
5. One instrumental bed, low. Lift it at each feature title; drop it out completely under the final line.

Performance — this is the 4% for Delivery

- **Smile on the first line of scene 2.** It is audible, and it buys you the opening.
- **Eyes on the lens**, never on your own preview. The biggest tell of a nervous pitch.
- **Four features means four gear changes.** Land a beat of silence before "And then the one that isn't about work at all" — it is the turn the whole video is built around.
- **Slow on numbers:** "seventy-eight", "eleven days", "eight hundred and eighty-one".
- **Scene 8 is slower and quieter** than everything before it. Conviction, not volume.
- Fluffed a line? Re-say it cleanly and keep rolling — fixing it in the edit costs eight seconds.

If the cut lands over 4:50 — trim in this order

1. **Scene 4e (-5s)** — drop the "+1h" tap. The sittings booking already made the point.
2. **Scene 6g (-4s)** — drop `/find-friends` and the last line of scene 6.
3. **Scene 1 (-4s)** — open on the blank document instead of the clock.
4. **Scene 3a (-4s)** — shorten the paste; land on the finished preview list.
5. **Scene 5c (-5s)** — cut "Could move" and go straight from the ranked list to the evening question.

Never cut: the 78% attendance card (0:58) · "book my sittings for me" (1:42) · the evening question (2:31) · **the whole of scene 6 up to and including the sharing screen (2:44–3:40) · the three-week plan graphic (3:57).**

That graphic is the only place the video answers "how will it be built", which is one of the host's four jobs.

Five ways teams lose Presentation marks

1. **Running over.** The host says it plainly: over five minutes *loses marks*. Export, watch, check the runtime.
2. **Explaining the ideation.** Marked from the README. Here it is a minute you cannot afford.
3. **Narrating the UI.** "Now I click here..." — say what it *means*; let the screen show the click.
4. **Showing everything.** The reason this plan has four features and not nine. Coverage is not a criterion; clarity is.
5. **Trailing off.** End on the line and the held card. No "...so, yeah, thanks for watching."